ACADEMIC CENTRAL

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

NC(V) LEVEL 3

ENGLISH FIRST ADDITIONAL LANGUAGE

PRACTICE EXAM

MARKS: 100 **TIME: 3 hours**

NC(V) fundamental subject, Level 3. Section A: Comprehension (30) · Section B: Summary (10) · Section C: Language in context – advertisement and language structures (25) · Section D: Writing (35). All texts were written by Academic Central.

Written by Academic Central for practice, following the NC(V) subject guidelines for NC(V) Level 3. It is not a Department of Higher Education and Training examination paper.

INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION

1. This question paper consists of FOUR sections: SECTION A: Comprehension (30), SECTION B: Summary (10), SECTION C: Language in context (25) and SECTION D: Writing (35).
2. Answer ALL the questions in Sections A, B and C. In Section D, answer ONE question from Question 4 and ONE question from Question 5.
3. Read all the texts carefully before you answer the questions.
4. Number your answers exactly as the questions are numbered.
5. Answer in full sentences unless you are told otherwise. Use your own words where asked.
6. Write neatly and legibly.

SECTION A: COMPREHENSION

QUESTION 1

Read the article below and answer the questions that follow.

Your Digital Footprint Is Your New CV

1 Ten years ago, an employer who wanted to know more about a job applicant would phone a few references. Today, many employers simply type the applicant's name into a search engine or look at his or her social media profiles. What they find there – your digital footprint – can open doors or close them before you are even invited for an interview.

2 A digital footprint is the trail of information you leave behind every time you use the Internet: the photos you post, the comments you write, the groups you join and even the posts you "like". Unlike words spoken in a taxi, these traces do not disappear. A screenshot can be taken in a second, and a post that you deleted years ago may still be stored somewhere on a server.

3 Recruitment agencies say that the most common reasons for rejecting candidates after an online check are offensive language, insults aimed at former employers, photos showing irresponsible behaviour and false information about qualifications. "If a candidate says on Facebook that she hates Mondays and her boss, I wonder how she will speak about my company," explains Thandeka Ndlovu, an HR manager at a logistics firm in Durban.

4 However, a digital footprint is not only a danger; it can also be a powerful tool. A professional profile on a networking site, a short video showing a project you built at college, or a blog in which you explain how you solved a technical problem can all show an employer your skills, your attitude and your ability to communicate. Many young people have been offered jobs because a manager saw their work online.

5 So how do you clean up your footprint? Experts suggest a simple three-step approach. First, search for your own name and see what appears. Second, delete or hide anything that you would not want a future employer – or your grandmother – to see, and tighten your privacy settings. Third,

start building a positive presence by sharing your achievements and commenting thoughtfully on topics related to your field.

6 Thandeka puts it simply: "Before you post, ask yourself whether you would be proud to see it on a billboard with your name under it. If the answer is no, don't post it."

1.1	According to paragraph 1, how did employers check applicants ten years ago?	(1)
1.2	Define a "digital footprint" in your own words.	(2)
1.3	Name THREE things that form part of a person's digital footprint.	(3)
1.4	The writer compares online posts with "words spoken in a taxi" (paragraph 2). Explain the point of this comparison.	(2)
1.5	Why is deleting a post not always enough to remove it? Give TWO reasons.	(2)
1.6	List FOUR reasons why candidates are rejected after an online check.	(4)
1.7	Explain why Thandeka Ndlovu is worried about the candidate who hates Mondays and her boss.	(2)
1.8	The word "However" begins paragraph 4. What change in the writer's argument does it introduce?	(2)
1.9	Give TWO examples of how a digital footprint can help a person get a job.	(2)
1.10	Why does the writer mention "your grandmother" in paragraph 5? What is the tone of this phrase?	(2)
1.11	Summarise the three-step approach to cleaning up a digital footprint.	(3)
1.12	Explain the billboard test that Thandeka suggests (paragraph 6).	(2)
1.13	Do you think it is fair for employers to judge applicants by their social media? Justify your answer.	(3)

[30]

SECTION B: SUMMARY

QUESTION 2

Read the text below. Summarise, in point form, SEVEN ways in which a student can save money while studying at a TVET college.

1. Write SEVEN points in full sentences, numbered 1 to 7.
2. Use your OWN words as far as possible.
3. Your summary must not be longer than 80 words. Write the number of words at the end.

Stretching Every Rand

Many students run out of money long before the end of the month, but a few simple habits can make a big difference. Start by drawing up a monthly budget so that you know exactly how much comes in and goes out. Cooking your own meals in bulk is far cheaper than buying takeaways every day. Instead of buying new textbooks, look for second-hand copies or borrow them from the

library. Where possible, walk or share lifts with classmates to cut transport costs. Always ask whether a student discount is available, because many shops and cellphone networks offer one. Avoid buying clothes or gadgets on credit, as the interest makes everything far more expensive. Finally, try to put away even a small amount each month in a savings account for emergencies.

[10]

SECTION C: LANGUAGE IN CONTEXT

QUESTION 3

Study the advertisement and answer the questions.

CONNECTPRO DATA – GO FURTHER, PAY LESS!

Students, why pay more when you can get **double the data** at half the price?

10 GB for only R99* – this month only!

Stream lectures, download notes and stay connected 24/7.

ConnectPro – because your future can't buffer.

*Valid for 30 days on the ConnectPro student plan. Night data (00:00–05:00) makes up 5 GB of the bundle. Student card required. Ts & Cs apply.

ConnectPro is a fictional company created for this examination.

3.1 Who is the target audience of this advertisement? Give a reason from the advertisement. (2)

3.2 Quote TWO examples of persuasive language used in the advertisement. (2)

3.3 Read the small print. Explain why the offer may be less attractive than it first seems. (2)

3.4 Explain the pun / double meaning in the slogan "because your future can't buffer". (2)

3.5 Rewrite in the passive voice: *Many shops offer student discounts.* (2)

3.6 Rewrite in reported speech: *Thandeka said, "I will check every applicant's profile tomorrow."* (3)

3.7 Complete the conditional sentence correctly: *If I had checked my privacy settings, …* (1)

3.8 Correct the concord error: *Neither the students nor the lecturer were aware of the change.* (1)

3.9 Identify the figure of speech: *A digital footprint is a permanent tattoo.* Explain its meaning. (2)

3.10 Give ONE word for: a person who applies for a job. (1)

3.11 Add a suitable prefix to make the opposite: (a) responsible (b) legal (2)

3.12 Change the sentence into a question beginning with "How": *Students can protect their privacy by changing their settings.* (1)

3.13 Rewrite the sentence in formal language: *The boss was totally gatvol with guys coming late.* (2)

3.14 Explain the difference between "affect" and "effect" by using each word in a sentence. (2)

[25]

SECTION D: WRITING

QUESTION 4: ESSAY

Write an essay of 250–300 words on ONE of the following topics. Give your essay a title.

4.1 Social media: a blessing or a curse for young people? [20]

4.2 Write a story that begins with the words: *"The message appeared on my screen at midnight …"* [20]

4.3 The skills that employers value most, and how I am developing them [20]

[20]

QUESTION 5: TRANSACTIONAL TEXT

Choose ONE of the following. Write 120–150 words. Use the correct format.

5.1 **Curriculum vitae.** Draw up a CV for a vacation job at a local company in your field of study. [15]

5.2 **Formal letter of complaint.** You bought a ConnectPro data bundle, but most of the data was night data that you could not use. Write a letter of complaint to the customer service manager. [15]

5.3 **Minutes.** Write the minutes of a Student Representative Council meeting at which the high cost of data for students was discussed. [15]

[15]

TOTAL: 100

END OF QUESTION PAPER